WORKING SHEETS

Write the mandate before the job description

A worksheet for founders hiring their first designer

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Describe the company stage

- [ ] Customer and product stage

- [ ] Design work happening today

- [ ] Why the role is needed now

Name the decisions the role should own

- [ ] Customer research decisions
- [ ] Product experience decisions
- [ ] Brand and product language decisions

Make the boundaries clear

- [ ] Decisions that remain with the founder
- [ ] Work the designer can reconsider
- [ ] Support or expertise they will need

Set the working relationships

- [ ] Product and engineering partners
- [ ] Access to customers and existing evidence
- [ ] How disagreements will be decided

Choose the first useful work

- [ ] Problem the designer should understand first

- [ ] Work already committed to

- [ ] Person currently making the relevant decisions

Check that the mandate is workable

- [ ] Responsibility without enough authority

- [ ] Evidence you will use to review the role

- [ ] Question to resolve before advertising